

Philipp Hilbert. *AI Product Owner, Banking & Fintech.*

Positioning, Product owner with 13 years in regulated industries, now specialising in AI use-case delivery for financial services platforms.

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§ WHY SBS

SBS sits at an intersection I find genuinely compelling: a global fintech platform powering core banking, payments, and digital banking for institutions across 80 countries, now building an AI layer on top of that foundation. The explicit mandate here, owning the DE AI use-case backlog end-to-end across DBS, OB and Premium AI, while acting as the single accountable interface between product squads, the SBS AI Platform team and engineering, is the kind of cross-domain orchestration role I have been building toward. What draws me specifically is the AI Council liaison function: structured governance of probabilistic systems in a regulated context is where careful product thinking prevents expensive production failures. *That is precisely where my combination of backlog discipline and AI deployment experience adds the most.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired development with engineering squads
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, evaluation loop design and edge-case generation
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping
- **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-ready deck production

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built zero-to-one.

- Designed and shipped an anonymity-until-payment model protecting both firms and workers until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents running qualification, matching and follow-up across the funnel.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one operator (me) runs the full day-to-day.
 - Demonstrates the agentic pattern directly relevant to SBS's AI use-case roadmap: multi-step LLM orchestration with a clear evaluation loop and human-in-the-loop guardrails.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SBS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the DE product squads and the SBS AI Platform team, map every current AI use case against the DBS, OB and Premium AI verticals, and surface where the backlog is thin, duplicated or missing acceptance criteria entirely.

WEEK 2

Sequence and validate.

Run a prioritisation pass with engineering and business stakeholders, assigning evaluation metrics and guardrail requirements to the top-five use cases so the squad knows exactly what "production-ready" means for each.

Ship and close loops.

Take the highest-priority use case through spec-to-release, instrument the post-launch feedback loop for adoption and drift, and establish the cadence for AI Council reporting.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at SBS,

I am applying for the Senior Product Owner role within your DE AI organisation. My background covers 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments and fintech, with a deliberate recent focus on AI and data platform delivery. The combination of backlog discipline, AI deployment experience and financial services domain knowledge you are describing maps directly onto what I have been doing.

On the AI and platform side: at Rohde & Schwarz I owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists. I introduced GitOps rollouts with ArgoCD that cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes, instrumented competing workflows to redirect strategy, and increased pipeline runs by 200% by making a data-driven call against a politically popular but unused UI. That is the kind of evidence-based prioritisation and engineering-ready spec work the DE AI backlog requires.

On the fintech and payments side: I co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payments product built inside the girocard ecosystem and later acquired and operated by Sparkasse. I have direct product experience designing payment flows, handling PSP integration edge cases and navigating the compliance constraints that come with operating inside a bank's infrastructure. I understand the difference between a payments feature that works in a demo and one that clears audit.

The post-launch feedback loop responsibility in this role, adoption, quality, drift, iteration, is one I take seriously rather than treating it as a monitoring afterthought. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I instrumented a national labour-market analytics platform, introduced Dagster and dbt to eliminate manual data-handling steps, and built evaluation tooling so the team could detect and correct data quality drift without hand-holding. The same discipline applies to LLM outputs: you need acceptance criteria that cover the probabilistic case, guardrails that trigger on drift, and a structured loop back into the backlog.

I work well at the interface between business stakeholders, AI Platform teams and engineering squads. I leave ego out of prioritisation decisions, document trade-offs transparently, and close

the loop after launch rather than moving immediately to the next feature. That is the posture this role needs, and it is how I operate.

I would welcome a conversation about how my experience maps to the specific use cases in the DE AI backlog.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product owner and product manager with 13 years in regulated industries, most recently owning an AI and data platform for a multinational defence programme and a national labour-market analytics platform. I run continuous discovery, translate validated use cases into engineering-ready specs with acceptance criteria and evaluation metrics, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. My fintech foundation, founding a P2P payments product acquired by Sparkasse and operating inside the girocard ecosystem, gives me direct domain knowledge of payments, banking infrastructure and compliance constraints.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, RAG, evaluation loops, guardrail design, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, product lifecycle management, go-to-market.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, GitOps rollout and rollback, CI/CD, defect-to-fix and cycle time as product metrics.

Analytics and Data: ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Fintech and Payments: P2P payments, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, payment flow design, KYC/AML-adjacent compliance, regulated financial product delivery.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance: GDPR/DSGVO, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

Owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum. GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes; workflow instrumentation redirected strategy and increased pipeline runs by 200%. Stack: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Python, Dagster, GitLab.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics platform; Deputy IT Security Officer. Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving 75% of time per data update; migrated bare-metal to containers; delivered full UI relaunch and large ETL migration in parallel. Stack: Dagster, dbt, Jenkins, OpenShift, PostgreSQL.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2023

Took a five-person team's overloaded roadmap and cut it to the top 10% of features: user acceptance rose fivefold. Integrated CGM hospital information system interface, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; senior-engineer attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL & PAYMENTS 2021-2022

POS and forecourt systems in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning; moved research results into production across a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT 2021

Secure data platform; data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER & PM · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER & PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption (OTP/true-RNG); shipped a three-layer product installing in under two minutes for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER & CFO · FINTECH PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments product; built from zero, acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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